

THE DATA ARCHITECT

Weekly observations on ownership, provenance and sovereignty

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CENTRAL OBSERVATION

Shared European capability creates shared data responsibility. Sovereignty is not just location: ownership, purpose, provenance, retention and recoverability must remain explicit across every organisational boundary.

WEEKLY SELECTION · FOUR DEVELOPMENTS FROM A WIDER SCAN OF POLICY, LAW, THREATS, STANDARDS AND TECHNOLOGY

DIGITAL EURO TESTS NEW DATA FLOWS

[3]

- FACT** The ECB opened a new digital euro innovation round. Experiments will use APIs and a test environment from January to June 2027; issuance is not decided.
- IMPACT** The ECB test environment will explore receipts, conditional payments, interfaces and public uses under privacy and user control principles.
- TENSION** Useful experimentation can create data that looks operational while ownership and evidential status remain unclear.
- DECISION** Define test data classes, purpose, lineage, deletion and the boundary to production records before participation.

CRITICAL COMMUNICATION NEEDS TRUSTED CONTEXT

[1]

- FACT** The Commission proposed a secure EU communication system for first responders. It must work across borders and when terrestrial networks are unavailable.
- IMPACT** Cross border response depends on timely identity, location, status and incident information when normal networks fail.
- TENSION** Minimal sharing protects confidentiality; richer context improves safety and coordination.
- DECISION** Specify the minimum data set, authority, provenance and offline reconciliation for degraded operation.

AI ENABLED DECEPTION ATTACKS DATA TRUST

[4]

- FACT** A Commission survey found three in four EU employees encountered suspicious digital contact. Phishing led at 39%; AI generated scams reached 15%.
- IMPACT** The survey shows material exposure to personal data theft, password theft and AI generated scams.
- TENSION** More signals improve detection but can expand workforce monitoring and retention.
- DECISION** Set lawful telemetry purposes, quality thresholds, retention and evidence requirements for detection data.

STRATEGIC TECHNOLOGY NEEDS DATA CONTINUITY

[2]

- FACT** A Commission study for the 2028 to 2034 funding cycle finds strong European science and regulation, but weak scale up and industrial adoption.
- IMPACT** The study calls for a connected route from research through scale and deployment.
- TENSION** Cross programme reuse can conflict with consent, licensing, commercial rights and national controls.
- DECISION** Add reusable data assets, rights, provenance and long term stewardship to research and funding governance.

SECTOR IMPACT

-  **PUBLIC SECTOR** DIRECT
Cross border response shares sensitive context. Define minimum set, authority and audit trail.
-  **FINANCIAL SERVICES** DIRECT
Payment tests create regulated data flows. Fix purpose, retention, lineage and reconciliation.
-  **HEALTHCARE** DIRECT
Emergency context may include health data. Test necessity, consent basis and offline integrity.
-  **ENERGY** DIRECT
Utility payment and incident data converge. Separate operational, customer and evidence records.
-  **LOGISTICS** CONDITIONAL
Movement and identity data cross borders. Validate provenance and data minimisation.
-  **INDUSTRY + MFG.** DIRECT
Scaling research needs reusable data rights. Record licence, lineage and stewardship.
-  **SERVICES** DIRECT
Detection data can become workforce data. Decide lawful purpose, access and deletion.

DECISION AGENDA

ACT NOW

Data owners: classify test, incident and telemetry data; assign purpose, retention and authoritative source.

ASSESS

Trace cross border lineage and degraded reconciliation; record where provenance or deletion cannot be proved.

WATCH

Follow digital euro privacy design and communication scope; translate when required fields are published.

TRIGGER

Reopen architecture if shared services require new sensitive data or prevent provable deletion and recovery.

PRIMARY SOURCES · CLICKABLE LINKS

[1] Commission · Critical communication · 30 Sep 2026

[3] ECB · Digital euro innovation call · 28 Sep 2026

[2] Commission · Strategic digital technology · 29 Sep 2026

[4] Commission · Workplace cyber threats · 30 Sep 2026

Consistent in Design. Powered by Logic.

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